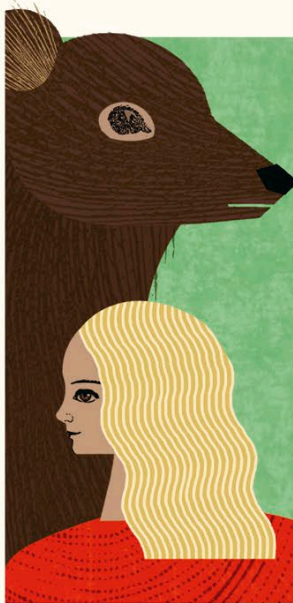




The Adventures of Atalanta

Atalanta was the daughter of King Iasos of Arcadia. Before her birth, her father had prayed to the gods that he would be blessed with a son.



When his wife gave birth to a daughter, Iasos was furious and abandoned the baby in the wilderness. The wailing Atalanta was discovered by a giant brown bear, but instead of attacking, the mother bear began to care for the human child.

The bear looked after Atalanta for many years and raised her in the wild.



As Atalanta grew into a woman, she proved to be a more skillful hunter and faster runner than anyone in all of Greece. Her fame spread, and she was approached by the hero Meleager. “Will you join my band of hunters and help us kill the Calydonian boar?” he asked. Atalanta readily agreed.

This boar was larger and more fearsome than any other, with tusks longer than those of an elephant. It had been sent by the goddess Artemis as a curse on Meleager’s father, the king of Calydon, who had angered her. It was Meleager’s duty as prince to catch the beast to protect his people.